

EU AI ACT

CLIENT SCENARIO BRIEFS

Consulting Exercise — Partner Copy

For each case below, review the client need, proposed AI behaviour, and affected population. As the consultant, determine the likely EU AI Act classification and the obligations or restrictions that apply. No category labels are provided — you must infer the legal treatment from the facts.

Client Scenario Briefs

Review all four cases. For each one, identify: (1) the likely EU AI Act tier, (2) the key legal reasoning, and (3) any obligations or recommended actions.

Case 1

Client need:

A digital investment platform wants to increase user engagement and trading activity by guiding users toward more optimal investment decisions and reducing impulsive behavior during market volatility.

Proposed AI behaviour:

The system will analyze user activity such as trading history, browsing patterns, reaction times, and interaction signals to infer behavioral states like hesitation, fear, or overconfidence. Based on these signals, it will dynamically adjust the interface, including highlighting specific assets, delaying or accelerating certain actions, and nudging users toward or away from trades. The system operates in real time without human review of individual interventions.

People affected:

Retail investors using the platform, whose investment decisions may be influenced by system-driven nudges based on inferred behavioral traits, without visibility into how or why these interventions occur.

Case 2

Client need:

A company responsible for maintaining waterway infrastructure wants to improve the efficiency and consistency of field inspections while reducing manual reporting effort for engineers.

Proposed AI behaviour:

The system will ingest voice recordings, images, and sensor data collected on-site. It will validate pre-identified damage suspicions, classify damage types, estimate severity, and suggest repair measures. It will generate structured inspection reports automatically, which engineers can review, edit, and approve before submitting them into the central system used for maintenance planning and budgeting.

People affected:

Field inspectors and office engineers who rely on the system's outputs to document and assess infrastructure conditions, as well as the broader public who depend on the safety and reliability of the infrastructure being inspected.

Case 3

Client need:

A booking platform for beauty and wellness services wants to improve customer experience and reduce operational workload by automating customer interactions and appointment management.

Proposed AI behaviour:

The system will act as a conversational assistant that helps users find providers, book appointments, reschedule services, and receive recommendations based on preferences and past behavior. It will handle interactions through chat and voice interfaces and complete most actions end-to-end. The system presents itself as a digital assistant but does not explicitly clarify whether responses are generated by AI.

People affected:

Platform users seeking services, who rely on the assistant for recommendations and booking decisions without always knowing whether they are interacting with an automated system or a human.

Case 4

Client need:

A startup developing a productivity tool wants to help teams reduce time spent on meeting follow-ups and improve alignment by automatically summarizing discussions and identifying next steps.

Proposed AI behaviour:

The system will process uploaded meeting recordings and transcripts to generate concise summaries and suggested action items. These outputs will be presented in a structured format and can be edited, approved, or discarded by users before being shared with others. The system functions as a drafting assistant and does not make or enforce decisions.

People affected:

Employees and team members using the tool to document meetings and coordinate tasks, whose work outputs may be influenced by AI-generated summaries that are subject to human review before use.

Petra's Scenarios — for review

Case 1

Client need: A national retail bank wants to reduce branch costs by automating loan application decisions. The bank serves a largely working-class customer base across several EU member states.

Proposed AI behaviour: The system will ingest behavioural signals from a customer's mobile banking app — spending patterns, time-of-day transaction habits, social network data purchased from a third-party data broker — and use them to produce a hidden creditworthiness modifier that adjusts the visible interest rate offer without the customer's awareness. No explanation is surfaced to the applicant.

People affected: Retail banking customers, predominantly lower-income households, who will receive differentiated loan terms without disclosure or meaningful opportunity to contest the outcome.

Case 2

Client need: A large logistics company operating in five EU countries wants to modernise its driver recruitment pipeline to reduce the manual workload on HR and improve consistency across regional hiring teams.

Proposed AI behaviour: The system will ingest CVs, structured application data, and video interview recordings. It will rank candidates automatically and produce a shortlist. Human recruiters will review only the shortlisted candidates; no recruiter will review applicants scored below the threshold.

People affected: Job applicants across the EU, including those from protected groups, who will be excluded from further consideration based solely on an automated score without individual human review of their application.

Case 3

Client need: An online travel agency wants to deploy a 24/7 customer support solution to handle booking modifications, refund requests, and destination FAQs in 12 languages, replacing a portion of its human agent capacity.

Proposed AI behaviour: A conversational AI will handle customer interactions end-to-end. It will present itself in a friendly, first-person style. The system will not proactively inform users they are speaking with an AI unless directly asked; the agency argues that disclosing AI status will reduce customer satisfaction scores.

People affected: Consumers interacting with the travel agency's support channel, who may not realise they are not communicating with a human agent and may make booking or refund decisions on that basis.

Case 4

Client need: A B2B SaaS company that sells project management software wants to reduce time spent by its engineering teams on internal ticket triage. Tickets are raised by internal staff only and concern software bugs and feature requests.

Proposed AI behaviour: The system will read new tickets submitted to an internal Jira board, classify them by type and estimated effort, and assign a suggested priority label. A human team lead reviews and accepts or overrides the label before any work is scheduled. No external users or personal data are involved.

People affected: Internal software engineering staff whose ticket queue sequencing may be influenced by AI-generated priority suggestions, subject to team lead override.

Caro's Scenarios — for review

Complete the four shells below with your own client scenarios. Remove any category hints before sharing back.

Partner Case 1: Mediscreen

Client need: A private hospital group operating across three EU member states is concerned about rising staff burnout rates. HR wants to implement a proactive wellbeing monitoring programme to identify at-risk employees early and reduce attrition among clinical and administrative staff.

Proposed AI behaviour: A third-party tool analyses facial expressions and vocal tone during mandatory weekly team video check-ins. After each session, the system generates a per-employee "stress and disengagement index" and delivers a dashboard summary to team leads. The vendor classifies the tool as a wellness solution, not a performance management system, and states that scores will not be used in formal appraisals. Employees are not shown their own scores and no override mechanism exists.

People affected: 4,200 clinical and administrative staff across three countries, who are subject to emotional state inference during mandatory work meetings without being informed of their individual results or given any means to contest them.

Partner Case B: BenefitCheck

Client need: A regional municipality in northern Germany wants to modernise its social housing subsidy programme. The volume of annual applications has outpaced caseworker capacity, creating processing backlogs and inconsistent outcomes across different offices.

Proposed AI behaviour: An off-the-shelf AI system ingests applicant data — income records, household composition, rental history, and prior benefit claims — and produces an eligibility recommendation for each application: approve, review, or decline. Caseworkers see the recommendation and supporting rationale on their dashboard and are required to confirm or override before a decision is issued. All decisions are logged with the caseworker's ID. The vendor has provided CE marking documentation, though the municipality's legal team has not yet reviewed it.

People affected: Approximately 11,000 applicants per year seeking access to housing subsidies, whose eligibility outcomes are shaped by an AI recommendation that caseworkers may confirm without independent re-examination of the underlying data.

Partner Case C: ShopBot

Client need: A Berlin-based online retailer specialising in sustainable clothing wants to reduce customer service costs and improve response times by deploying an AI assistant across its website and mobile app.

Proposed AI behaviour: A conversational AI powered by a third-party LLM handles customer enquiries about sizing, materials, delivery, and returns, and proactively suggests products based on browsing history and stated preferences. It can initiate partial refunds up to €30 without human review. The assistant uses a human-sounding name and avatar. The vendor's terms place all disclosure obligations on the retailer; the retailer has not yet added any AI identification notice to the interface.

People affected: Approximately 18,000 customers per month who interact with the assistant without being informed they are communicating with an AI system, and who may make purchasing or return decisions on that basis.

Partner Case D: AdOptimizer

Client need: A Hamburg-based digital marketing agency wants to reduce the manual workload on its performance team by automating the optimisation of paid social campaigns managed on behalf of brand clients.

Proposed AI behaviour: A Hamburg-based digital marketing agency wants to reduce the manual workload on its performance team by automating the optimisation of paid social campaigns managed on behalf of brand clients.

People affected: The agency's performance team, whose campaign management workflow is partially automated, and indirectly the brand clients whose campaign parameters are adjusted by the system within agreed performance targets.